

PANAGIOTIS SOLAKIDIS

TECHNICAL DESIGN SYSTEMS LEADER & SYSTEMS ARCHITECT

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Technical Design Systems Leader & Systems Architect

Specializing in Unified Design Systems, Token-to-Code Parity, Cross-Platform UI Architectures & Technical Design Leadership

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Systems-driven Technical Design Leader with 10 years of cumulative experience managing complex software architectures, design systems, and multidisciplinary squads. Expert in evolving unified design systems beyond simple maintenance, establishing direct token-to-code parity, and bridging the design-engineering gap. Active practitioner of Figma-to-code automation, leveraging React prototyping to validate complex component states. Former Hellenic Air Force Officer with a background in anti-aircraft missile systems, bringing military-grade systemic precision, high-velocity sync leadership, and structured execution to flat, fast-paced product organizations.

CORE SKILLS

- Design Systems & Token Governance:** Scaling global UI libraries, token-to-code programmatic mapping, Figma variables, auto-layout, system refactoring (**Sol Design System**).
- Technical Design Operations (DX):** Code-level prototyping in React, Cursor/Claude-assisted development workflows, MCP tool integrations.
- Leadership & Team Mentorship:** Managing and mentoring designers, establishing system contribution guidelines, cross-functional squad alignment.
- Platform & Cross-Platform Architecture:** Design pattern definition across iOS, Android, and Web, internal product vision, API integrations.
- Agile & Strategic Execution:** Product trios (PM, EM, Lead Designer), backlog grooming, technical specification authoring, rapid iteration delivery.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Product Designer & Systems Architect | Desquared SA

Oct 2023 — Present * **Design System Scaling & Governance:** Spearheaded the strategy, restructuring, and scaling of the *Sol Design System* (expanding from 2,200+ to 3,500+ variants), establishing programmatic token structures synced with production code to reduce front-end debt by 40%. * **Design Leadership & Mentoring:** Managed and mentored a team of product designers, establishing clear system contribution frameworks and ensuring unified design guidelines across multiple squads. * **Technical Design Operations:** Utilized advanced AI workflows (Cursor, Claude Code, MCP) to automate documentation and code functional React prototypes, verifying complex component behaviors directly in the browser. * **Agile Alignment & Strategy:** Partnered in product trios with Product and Engineering Leads to define platform-level vision, groom sprint backlogs, and deliver technical specifications for high-impact releases.

Product Designer / Systems Designer | Desquared SA

July 2020 — Oct 2023 * **Core Platform & Component Design:** Co-owned the system-wide core components and cross-platform navigation libraries used for the *Wave Grocery* and *BOX* apps, serving millions of users and thousands of merchants. * **Interactive Code Prototyping:** Built state-based, interactive prototypes in React to validate complex authorization matrices, transaction states, and API-driven user flows prior to engineering handoff. * **Usability & Accessibility Governance:** Led comprehensive heuristic audits and user research to achieve strict WCAG/ADA accessibility compliance across all web and mobile platforms.

Lieutenant (Anti-Aircraft Missile Systems) | Hellenic Air Force

2016 — 2020 * **Operational Command & Precision:** Commanded military tactical units, overseeing complex software-hardware operations and telemetry systems under high-stakes conditions. * **Structured Leadership & Agile Syncs:** Led daily briefs, training drills, and technical maintenance syncs, building high accountability, discipline, and alignment across diverse teams.

EDUCATION

- **UX Immersion Program** | CareerFoundry (2019 – 2020)
- **B.S. in Military Sciences** | Hellenic Air Force Academy (2012 – 2016)